

Oakwood Primary School

Admissions Information 2025-26

Oakwood Lane, Millbrook, MB12 4ST
Tel: 01234 567890 | Email: office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk

Welcome to Oakwood

Thank you for considering Oakwood Educational Academy for your child's primary education. We are a happy, inclusive school where every child is valued and supported to reach their full potential.

This guide provides information about our admissions process for children starting in Reception (the first year of primary school) in September 2025.

Key Information

School Type: Academy (part of Peninsula Schools Trust)
Age Range: 4-11 years (Reception to Year 6)
Number of Places: 60 places per year group (2 classes of 30)
Published Admission Number (PAN): 60 for Reception 2025

Important Dates for September 2025 Entry

Date	Event
15th January 2025	Application deadline (apply via Devon County Council)
16th April 2025	Offer day (you'll receive your allocation by email)
30th April 2025	Deadline to accept or decline your place

Date	Event
June 2025	New Reception parent meetings and transition visits
Wednesday 3rd September 2025	First day for new Reception children

How to Apply

Step 1: Check Eligibility

Your child must be 4 years old by 31st August 2025 to start Reception in September 2025.

Children born between: - 1st September 2020 - 31st August 2021: Start Reception September 2025

Step 2: Apply Online

Applications must be made through Devon County Council, not directly to the school.

Apply online at: www.devon.gov.uk/admissions

Application period: Opens 9th September 2024

Deadline: 15th January 2025 (midnight)

 **Late applications** will be processed after all on-time applications and are much less likely to receive an offer from your preferred school.

Step 3: List Your Preferences

You can list up to three schools in order of preference. You should use all three preferences to maximize your chances of getting a school place.

We recommend: 1. Your preferred school (e.g., Oakwood) 2. Another school you would be happy with 3. Your catchment area school (if different) as a safety option

Step 4: Wait for Offer Day

All applicants will receive an email on **16th April 2025** with their school allocation.

Step 5: Accept or Decline

You have until **30th April 2025** to accept or decline your place.

Admissions Criteria

If Oakwood receives more applications than we have places available, places are allocated using the following criteria (in order):

1. Children in Care and Previously in Care

Children who are looked after or were previously looked after (including children adopted from care).

2. Siblings

Children who have a sibling at the school at the time of admission.

Definition of sibling: - Brother or sister - Half-brother or half-sister - Step-brother or step-sister
- Adopted brother or sister - Living at the same address

Note: Siblings in Year 6 who will leave before September 2025 do NOT count.

3. Medical or Social Grounds

Children for whom there are exceptional medical or social reasons for attending the school (supported by professional evidence).

4. Distance

Children living nearest to the school, measured by the shortest walking route using public roads and footpaths.

Catchment Area

Oakwood has a defined catchment area. Living in the catchment area does **NOT guarantee a place** - you must still apply and places are allocated according to the oversubscription criteria.

Our catchment area includes the following postcodes: - EX4 2 (most addresses) - EX4 4 (Pinhoe Road area) - EX2 7 (parts of Beacon Heath)

To check if your address is in catchment:

Use the Devon County Council catchment checker at:
www.devon.gov.uk/catchmentchecker

School Tours

We warmly welcome prospective parents to visit our school and see us in action!

Scheduled Tours for September 2025 Entry

Tours take place on the **first Tuesday of each month** at **9:30am**: - 1st October 2024 - 5th November 2024 - 3rd December 2024 - 7th January 2025

Booking is essential - spaces are limited to 10 families per tour.

To book: Email office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk or call 01234 567890

What to expect: - Welcome from Mrs. Mitchell (Headteacher) - Tour of classrooms and facilities
- Meet our Reception team - Opportunity to ask questions - Duration: approximately 60 minutes

Please note: Tours are for adults only - we cannot accommodate children on tour days.

Starting School

Can My Child Start Part-Time?

All children are entitled to attend full-time from the beginning of the school year. However, we understand some children may benefit from a gradual introduction.

Our approach: - **First week (Sept 3-5):** All children attend mornings only (8:50am - 12:00pm) -
Second week onwards (from Sept 8): Full days for all children

If you feel your child needs a more gradual start, please discuss this with the Headteacher.

Can I Defer Entry?

If your child's 5th birthday is between September and March, you may defer entry until later in the academic year, or request part-time attendance, but **they must start by the term after they turn 5.**

Summer-born children (born April-August): You may request delayed entry to Reception the following year. This is not automatic and must be discussed with the school and Local Authority.

For more information, contact the admissions team at: educationandfamilies@devon.gov.uk

In-Year Admissions (Moving to the Area)

If you need a school place during the school year (not September Reception intake), the process is different:

For Year Groups with Available Spaces:

1. Apply via Devon County Council: www.devon.gov.uk/admissions
2. The school will be asked if we have space
3. If space available, you'll be offered a place
4. Start date agreed with the school

For Year Groups That Are Full:

1. Apply via Devon County Council
2. Your child will be added to the waiting list
3. If a space becomes available, it will be offered to the child highest on the waiting list (using the same criteria as initial admissions)

Advice: If moving to the area, apply as early as possible to maximize chances of getting your preferred school.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I have a guaranteed place because I live in catchment?

No. Living in catchment does not guarantee a place. You must still apply and will be considered alongside all other applicants using our admissions criteria.

What if I don't get my first choice?

You will be allocated one of your preferences if possible. If none of your preferences can offer a place, Devon County Council will allocate the nearest school with spaces available. You can join waiting lists for your preferred schools.

Can I appeal if my child doesn't get a place?

Yes. You have the right to appeal. Appeal forms and information will be sent with your allocation letter if unsuccessful.

When should I apply if we're moving house?

Apply as soon as you know your new address. If you haven't moved yet, you may use your current address but should notify the council as soon as you have proof of your new address.

My child has special educational needs - what should I do?

If your child has an Education, Health and Care Plan (EHCP), their place is allocated through a different process. Contact the SEN team at Devon County Council: 0345 155 1005

Can I visit the school before applying?

Absolutely! We encourage all families to visit. See "School Tours" section above for dates and booking.

Is there a breakfast or after-school club?

Yes, we offer wraparound care from 7:45am and until 5:30pm. More information will be provided at new parent meetings.

What if my child turns 5 after September?

All children born between 1st September 2020 and 31st August 2021 start Reception in September 2025, regardless of when in that period their 5th birthday falls.

Does attending the nursery next door guarantee a place?

No. Attendance at any nursery does not affect your application. You must still apply through the normal process.

Contact Information

For General Admissions Questions

Oakwood Educational Academy

Phone: 01234 567890

Email: office@oakwood-primary.sch.uk

Ask for Mrs. Davies (Office Manager)

For Application Process Questions

Devon County Council Admissions Team

Phone: 0345 155 1019

Email: admissions@devon.gov.uk

Website: www.devon.gov.uk/admissions

Opening hours: Monday-Friday, 8:30am-5:00pm

What Happens Next?

1. **Visit our school** - Book a tour to see if Oakwood is right for your family
 2. **Apply on time** - Deadline is 15th January 2025
 3. **Wait for offer day** - 16th April 2025
 4. **Accept your place** - By 30th April 2025
 5. **Attend new parent meetings** - June 2025
 6. **Your child starts school** - September 2025!
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We look forward to welcoming your family to Oakwood Educational Academy!

Mrs. Sarah Mitchell

Headteacher

Oakwood Educational Academy

Growing Together, Learning Forever

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For the most up-to-date information, please visit: www.oakwood.sch.uk/admissions